FINANCIAL NEED

I am the second person in my family to graduate high school, and the first to attend college. Both of my parents dropped out of school when they were teenagers, however, years before my high school graduation, my father left my family. Due to my mother and brother's limited education, they have always worked in entry-level positions, earning barely enough to put food on the table. As a first-generation college student, I am in need of financial aid because I do not have anyone to contribute to my education. My mother is the only person that has paid for my expenses up until now. As of right now, my mother is the one that pays to keep me fed and in a home, but I have been paying for my education this year. I am fortunate enough to have won a 1,000 scholarship during my senior year, which has been my primary source of paying for my education. My mother is not able to support me financially because she struggles enough and lives paycheck to paycheck. My mother and brother cannot contribute to my college expenses, and I do not have a lot of opportunities of getting a full-time job because I am underage. A scholarship would help me avoid costly student loans that could take years to repay.

ACADEMIC AND CAREER GOALS

As it gives me the chance to explore two of my passions - solving issues and creating engaging experiences - I decided to pursue a degree in computer science. I can come up with challenges that are unique to a user, create and brainstorm potential solutions, and then implement them using code. The study of mathematical sciences has intrigued me for many years. I plan on graduating with an associate's degree in science and an emphasis in computer science in the Spring of 2024. Soon after receiving my associate's degree, I will transfer as a full-time student to Arizona State University and continue studying for a bachelor's degree. From my perspective, success looks like an individual accomplishing their dreams and having financial freedom. Although fulfilling one's dreams can be challenging for individuals, success means having little to no opportunities to achieve one's goals, but doing whatever is necessary to reach them anyways. After graduating with my associate's degree, I plan on interning at a software company that will allow me to gain exceptional work experience. When I graduate with my bachelor's degree in the same major, I intend to be employed as a full-time software engineer.

EMPLOYMENT, EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES OR VOLUNTEER COMMUNITY SERVICE

I do not currently have a job, and I do not intend to get one until I turn 18 years old. The majority of my weekdays are spent following a schedule that includes having breakfast, leaving early for school, attending my classes, and returning home to participate in my online programs. Then, after completing any outstanding assignments for my classes, I would continue my late-night exercise regimen. I worked at my school's events all year long when I was still in high school, including Produce On Wheels, and I served as the Interact club and garden committee chairperson for two years. I volunteered as a packer for some veggies, giving the finished product to the guests and occasionally assisting families in carrying produce to cars. I took part in making a garden at the side entrance to my school through the Interact club and the garden committee. Throughout my time in high school, I was inspired to volunteer since spending time with many of my friends and coworkers outside of class helped me manage my stress and

helped me develop an upbeat outlook on life. At the community college I attend, I am not currently a part of any student organizations, but I have chosen to spend some of my leisure time playing sports. Both positive and negative experiences are crucial for growing as a leader because they force you to step outside of your comfort zone, test your talents, and question and challenge them. A satisfying experience will help you maintain your sense of optimism and confidence in your communication abilities and will give you the chance to think back on the actions you did to lead a team in order to use them in another circumstance. Negative experiences, on the other hand, can help you think about what went wrong in the circumstance and how you can use what you learned to improve your conflict management abilities. This gives you the chance to learn about the reality of working life on a daily basis and gives you the necessary adaptive skills.

WHAT DOES RECEIVING A SCHOLARSHIP MEAN TO YOU

Although education can lead to many opportunities, having goals become a reality depends on the initiative. A scholarship would provide me the chance to pursue the career of my dreams, which is to become a software engineer for a technological company. I can make a difference in the tough and continuously changing area of the technology industry if I were to receive a scholarship. Despite their best efforts, my family has never been able to pay for my college expenses. I am already taking steps to reduce the cost of a computer science degree, like enrolling at a community college. A scholarship will help me lower the momentary barriers to earning a degree, and in turn, my full focus can remain on studying, learning, and excelling. With a scholarship, I will be able to devote all of my attention and effort to performing well in my classes and continue to contribute to my school and community.

IF WE RAN YOUR NAME THROUGH AN INTERNET/SOCIAL MEDIA SEARCH, WOULD WE ENCOUNTER ANYTHING NEGATIVE THAT WOULD HAMPER YOUR ABILITY TO SERVE ON THE GOVERNING BOARD OR VIOLATE MARICOPA'S EXPECTATIONS FOR STUDENT CONDUCT?

Running my name through an internet or social media search will not show any negative wrongdoing actions. I currently do not occupy a social media account for personal use, however, I am willing to do so for marketing or professional purposes only.

There are no wrongful behaviors or misdemeanors associated with me when you search for my name on the internet or social media. I don't currently utilize social media for personal purposes, but will do so for marketing and professional purposes only.

WHAT DO YOU HOPE TO ACCOMPLISH BY SERVING AS A STUDENT MEMBER OF THE GOVERNING BOARD?

As a student member of the governing board, I will communicate with the students, school staff, and faculty to increase the visibility of community engagement. I will also provide useful information about the student experience and gain insight on what issues they are undergoing the most. With these issues, I hope to gather information and address what solutions are available to the Governing Board.

As a student member of the Governing Board, I hope to interact with the teachers, staff, and students, to make community engagement more visible. Additionally, I'll share pertinent information regarding the student experience and learn more about the problems they face most frequently. I want to learn more about these concerns and discuss available solutions to the Governing Board. Overall, I hope to gain insight on student life and how the Governing Board is able to provide multiple opportunities for a student's success.

WHAT DO YOU SEE AS THE MAJOR ISSUES AND ACTIVITIES RELATING TO MARICOPA COMMUNITY COLLEGE STUDENTS THAT SHOULD BE CONSIDERED BY THE GOVERNING BOARD?

Many of the issues relating to maricopa community college students revolve around the mental wellbeing of these individuals. There are also issues that involve transportation, financial abilities, and the ability to afford food, however, there are a variety of opportunities that already combat these issues. The majority of students undergo academic and social pressure, do not study effectively, and have to work a full-time job in order to make payments for educational and personal responsibilities. These mental health challenges can impact the academic performance and success of students.

WHAT DO YOU FEEL YOU CAN CONTRIBUTE IN THESE AREAS?
Promote academic advising

Based on the issues indicated, I feel like I can promote academic advising, provide campus-wide mental health resources, and promote mentl health awareness throughout campuses. These opportunities could be beneficial for students, allowing them to seek support which could be the key to their academic success.

PERSONAL GOALS

As it gives me the chance to explore two of my passions - solving issues and creating engaging experiences - I decided to pursue a degree in computer science. I plan on graduating with an associate's degree in science and an emphasis in computer science in the Spring of 2024. Soon after receiving my associate's degree, I will transfer as a full-time student to Arizona State University and continue studying for a bachelor's degree. After graduating with my associate's degree, I plan on interning at a software company that will allow me to gain exceptional work experience. When I graduate with my bachelor's degree in the same major, I intend to be employed as a full-time software engineer.

Describe your personal, academic and career goals and what you believe impacted or led you to these goals. Also, briefly explain your vision of your professional life and contributions to your community after graduation from the university. Please limit your response to 3000 characters (~500 words).

The first physical science class I took at Estrella Mountain Community College was University Physics I: Mechanics. Throughout the semester, my professor had assigned many programming projects that incorporated the concepts we were learning. For our final project, she gave us an assignment where we had to demonstrate a rocket launch simulation, implementing logical forces with the concepts taught to us earlier in the semester. I spent most of my time enjoying her class and learning the concepts to the best of my ability to later write a program about it. As it gives me the chance to explore two of my passions - solving issues and creating engaging experiences - I decided to pursue a degree in computer science. I plan on graduating with an Associate's degree in science with an emphasis in computer science in the Spring of 2024. Soon after receiving my Associate's degree, I will transfer as a full-time student to Arizona State University and continue studying for a bachelor's degree. After graduating with my Associate's degree, I plan on interning at a software company that will allow me to gain exceptional work experience. When I graduate with my Bachelor's degree in the same major, I intend to be employed as a full-time software engineer and attend graduate school. After graduation from Arizona State University, I plan on using my degree to pursue a full-time position as a software-engineer. Some of the ways that I will contribute to my community is by providing open-source projects, volunteering, mentoring, and networking. As a software engineer, I could easily sell my advice to gain profit from it. Instead, providing open-source projects and teaching the things I know for free, is something that I would benefit the community. I will also volunteer with charities that provide scholarships, stipends, or some type of financial support for women studying in S.T.E.M. fields, because I was able to relate so much throughout my years of studying. Mentoring and networking with students pursuing S.T.E.M. degrees at community colleges is something that I look forward to doing. I will be able to provide

more opportunities for underrepresented students and offer meaningful relationships between themselves and I.

Describe your service experiences. Please include organization information, your roles, and length of service. Please limit your response to 3000 characters (~500 words).

Student ambassador
I serve as an ambassador for the Student Life & Leadership Department. I work 20 hours a week at the Student Union building at Estrella Mountain Community College (EMCC). The essential functions of this role are to provide students with different resources, such as our food pantry, clothing boutique, the child care assistance program, and our bus transit program. Throughout this role, my coworkers and I occasionally stock up the food pantry with a variety of snacks and microwavable meals. Though the food pantry is open and free to all EMCC students, the main purpose of this resource is to provide free food for students with financial need. I also create food boxes for families, students, and staff members every month. Additionally, while serving this role, we host many events each month, dedicated to the students of the college. The clothing boutique is another resource where we focus on providing free professional clothing, business attire, casual clothing and accessories for students. The Maricopa District has 10 total student senators, one for each community college campus. As a student senator, I represent Estrella Mountain Community College, and I gather concerns and issues that students are facing on my campus. I not only bring them up to the monthly senate meetings at Tempe's Rio Salado Conference Tower, but I also bring it up to Maricopa's Governing Board. This position will allow student's voices to be heard on my campus and on other campuses. The Coffee Talk was an event that I faciliated, where we provided students and teachers with free coffee and donuts. During this time, the President, Vice-Presidents, and Deans of the campus were guests and spokespeople. The purpose of this event was for students in the audience to voice their concerns, issues, and questions to one of the guests, and they would answer to the best of their ability. I was on the panel with our guests, asking starter questions, which later engaged the audience to speak for themselves. The Leadership Council is composed of the President, Vice-Presidents, Deans, and Faculty members of the college campus. There is only one student member for each academic year, and I serve as that member. I serve as a student representative for the Student Life & Leadership Department, thus, during the Leadership Council meetings, I give a report of what events and activities our department has planned for the next few weeks. The meetings are held each second and fourth wednesday of the month. I have been working as a student ambassador since July of 2023 and

am still employed. The student senator role is served only for one-year terms, thus, my term is from August of 2023 to May of 2024. The coffee talk event lasted for only two hours on October 16, 2023.

PREVIOUS RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

In the spring semester of 2023, a faculty mathematics professor offered me to take part in an undergraduate research project called Hidden Figures. My teammates and I were given a stipend for the research as we were sponsored by ASU's WAESO program. The whole project was done at Estrella Mountain Community College (where we all studied) in Arizona. The flight of the Friendship 7 capsule in the Mercury Atlas-6 mission aimed to place a man into Earth's orbit and have him successfully re-enter the Earth's atmosphere. The novel and film "Hidden Figures" were based on this mission, where a team of female African American mathematicians served a vital role in launching John Glenn into orbit. Using the calculations from Technical Note D-233, my teammates and I conducted a computational examination of the capsule's trajectory. Using the data from the launch of the Atlas-6 rocket and Friendship 7 capsule, we made a rocket launch simulation using the general-purpose programming language, python. We applied the navigational orbital mechanics calculations and other parameters to our code, using a modern approach to determining the azimuthal angle. The timeline of this project was throughout the whole Spring semester of 2023, where we later presented our findings at the Arizona-Nevada Academy of Science Annual Conference.

What makes you excited about this REU site? Find more information about our theme and specific projects on our website. Also think about our department, Emory university, and the location in general.

Computational experience: Briefly describe your experience in using computers and computer programming

Throughout my academic years at a community college, I've done research related to computer science, mathematics, and physics. I've had experience in using computers and computer programming inside and outside of the class. In a past class, I learned about the hardware aspects of computers, including microprocessors and assembly language. In many of the

classes I have previously taken, I learned and implemented programming languages like Java, Python, C, and C++. I have been using Java and Python for about 2 years now, and am looking forward to continuing my knowledge of these programs.

What makes you excited about being a participant in the REU program?

A combination of many factors gets me excited about being a participant in the REU program. From my previous research experience, I grew to love the exploration of research interests, especially physics. Hands-on research experience is something that makes me very enthusiastic about the program. This program provides the opportunity for students to engage in real-world scenarios and apply them to different industries. The hands-on experience in a subject that inspires me is what seems so thrilling to me. The network opportunities that may come from this experirence also excites me about this program. I will be able to interact with other student leaders and professionals in the field.